Established in Bengaluru in 1999 when the city was on the cusp of a software boom, the growth trajectory of Kristu Jayanti (Deemed to be University) since then has reflected the rapid pace of the new millennium—it became autonomous in 2013, and transitioned into a university in 2025. Having started off with just nine students in 1999, its total intake since inception will hit 18,000 this year.

"Nothing is accidental here. It is planned," says vice chancellor Fr Dr Augustine George. "As an institution, we are ambitious. That is reflected in our NAAC and NIRF scores." He credits his team and the robust academic framework for setting this pace. The underlying factor, says Fr George, is the value systems and learner-centric culture that the institute has nurtured.

Established in 2003, the social work programme has its key focus on promoting immersive field work and training. "The curriculum features robust, structured field placement with concurrent field work in NGOs, hospitals and community-based organisations bridging theoretical concepts with hands-on experience," says Dr Aloysius Edward J., registrar. With a MSW (Master of Social Work) degree on offer, the approach focuses on skill development, project-based and experiential learning via rural camps and social work labs. "The foundational pillar of the social work programme is research, and project proposal formulation and presentation," says Edward. "The main facets of social work include compassion, integrity, intervention and service. Students need to be active, so we have over 250 field work partners across the country," he says. The concurrent field work usually leads to placements, he adds. In recent years, the programme at Kristu Jayanti has seen a rapid rise through the ranks: from No. 14 in 2022, it stands at No. 8 this year, making it the most improved college in this category.

Located at Kothanur in north-eastern Bengaluru, Kristu Jayanti's 10-acre campus is a spotlessly clean verdant patch, with tree-lined walkways amidst the academic blocks. Students participate in cleanliness and plastic-free drives on campus, which, says the VC, is part of inculcating a sense of pride and ownership. Similarly, on the academics and curriculum delivery front, the institute ensured that the goals were clearly understood by the faculty members, he says. "Now, we are focusing more on a research framework...how we can develop micro research groups on our campus and create an environment for both students and faculty members to be involved," says Fr George.

"As a higher education institution, we are aware of the resources that we have to develop," says the VC. "From a small college to an autonomous college, and now we are a university." A year after acquiring that status, Kristu Jayanti is gearing up for a new phase of expansion starting with a second, state-of the art campus in Bengaluru, set to open in July. It will house an exclusive management school. In its long-term roadmap, the university plans to expand beyond Bengaluru.■

GURUSPEAK



"We are keenly aware of the resources that we have to develop. Over the years, we started developing human resources, facilities; now we're working on the network resources"

FR DR AUGUSTINE GEORGE
Vice chancellor, Kristu Jayanti (Deemed to be University)

TOP 5 MOST IMPROVED COLLEGES SOCIAL WORK

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY	RANK 2026	RANK 2022
1	KRISTU JAYANTI (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY)	Bengaluru	8	14
2	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIOLOGY, BANASTHALI VIDYAPITH	Banasthali Vidyapith	14	22
3	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WORK, MADRAS CHRISTIAN COLLEGE	Chennai	7	10
4	HINDUSTHAN COLLEGE OF ARTS & SCIENCE (AUTONOMOUS)	Coimbatore	25	34
5	PRASANNA SCHOOL OF PUBLIC HEALTH, MAHE	Manipal	13	17

*The college that has shown the highest improvement in rankings between 2022 and 2026